

PHYSICAL SECURITY AUDIT

Building: 125 College Way, Sydney, NS

Client Management - 'E' Wing Facility

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0.0 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report details the physical security assessment of the repurposed 'E' Wing of the former NSCC Marconi Campus. As the facility handles sensitive government data, the security posture must align with the *Treasury Board Policy on Government Security* (PGS). The audit evaluated safeguards for personnel and assets, focusing on the server room, ingress/egress points, and network infrastructure.

Key Findings: The facility currently presents a **High Risk** and is not fit for purpose. Critical vulnerabilities include an unfenced perimeter with an unmonitored second-floor pedway , unsecure industrial loading doors , and a server room lacking secure containment. Immediate remediation is required, specifically the installation of fencing, decommissioning of industrial bays, and physical hardening of the server room.

1.0 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background & Objective: A former skilled trades building, the 'E' Wing is a standalone structure co-located with non-government entities, meaning central access to the wider campus is not controlled by the tenant. There are industrial elements that conflict with secure government data handling standards. This audit aims to evaluate the physical security control frameworks currently in place and recommend improvements, with a focus on the exterior perimeter, access points, and server room.

1.2 Methodology: This assessment adheres to the *Harmonized Threat and Risk Assessment (TRA) Methodology* and evaluates compliance against the *Directive on Security Management (2019)* and the *Nova Scotia Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act* (FOIPOP).

2.0 FINDINGS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

2.1 Governance & Risk Management - Observation: No facility-specific Threat and Risk Assessment (TRA) exists, and there is no formal agreement with the landlord regarding security responsibilities for shared grounds. **Recommendation (R1, R2):** Immediately conduct a facility-

specific TRA. Concurrently, establish a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) with the landlord defining a security exclusion zone to mandate cooperation on perimeter control (PGS 4.1.9).

2.2 Exterior Perimeter - Observation: The property is unfenced and accessible from public parking. A pedway connects to the second floor, creating an unmonitored secondary access vector that bypasses ground-level checks. **Recommendation (R3, R4):** Install security-grade fencing to designate a controlled zone, permitted up to 8ft without engineered plans by CBRM bylaws. Implement monitored checkpoints at main entry roads to screen traffic before it reaches the facility. The pedway must either be integrated into the secured perimeter or permanently sealed.

2.3 Access Points - Observation: Two large industrial loading-bay doors remain near the server room, presenting a massive vulnerability for attacks from vehicles and piggybackers. Additionally, multiple single-person pedestrian doors lack sufficient locking mechanisms. **Recommendation (R5, R6):** If retained for emergency use, the doors must be reinforced with steel plating and magnetic contacts. Pedestrian entry points should be merged into to one primary door that is secured with 2FA.

2.4 Server Room - Observation: The Server Room is centrally located near a public corridor and secured only by a standard single door without physical hardening. Two windows on the sides of the walls pose confidentiality risks. **Recommendation (R7):** Harden the Server Room into a Secure Containment Area. This requires slab-to-slab wall reinforcement, removing the windows, and a metal door with high-security locks, and dedicated internal CCTV systems.

2.5 Detection & Surveillance - Observation: The facility lacks an Intrusion Detection System (IDS). Four existing external cameras are in place, but there is no evidence of a Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA) or signage. **Recommendation (R8, R9):** Implement a 24/7 monitored IDS covering all perimeter doors, windows, and the pedway. Conduct an assessment for existing cameras to ensure compliance with *Nova Scotia FOIPOP* and *Video Surveillance Guidelines*, and outline novel positioning plans for new camera installations.

2.6 Internal Controls - Observation: No environmental monitoring exists for the server room, and lighting levels in the loading bay area appear insufficient for CCTV. **Recommendation (R10, R11):** Deploy environmental sensors for moisture and temperature in the server room. Conduct a lighting survey to ensure that the perimeter's illumination meets standards.

3.0 ANALYSIS OF KEY SECURITY ISSUES

3.1 Perimeter Vulnerability: The shell of the building is lined with access points. College Way, the street allows unvetted vehicles to approach the structure, increasing the risk of vehicle-borne attacks. Without monitored checkpoints at road ingress points or a perimeter fence, the facility lacks the required stand-off distance needed for high-security government assets. Additionally, the pedway allows entry directly to the second floor, bypassing ground-floor hardening.

3.2 Server Room: The Server Room is the facility's "crown jewel" but currently relies on a standard office door. This fails to meet the "detect, delay, respond" principles of the *Directive on Security Management*. To process sensitive information, this room must be hardened. Two large bay doors are in close proximity to the location of the server room, and must be sealed or reinforced.

3.3 Privacy & Compliance Risks: Using external cameras without a clear policy framework creates legal liability under Nova Scotia's *PIIDPA* and *FOIPOP*. Surveillance must be justifiable and transparent; unmonitored cameras provide a false sense of security while exposing the organization to privacy complaints.

4.0 MANAGEMENT ACTION PLAN

The following plan prioritizes actions based on risk severity and governance compliance.

Priority	Reference #	Action Item	Responsibility	Target
Tier 1 Government	R1, R2	Governance: Conduct TRA and sign MOU with landlord regarding the security zone.	Chief Security Officer	Q1 2026
Tier 2 Critical	R5, R7	Hardening: Decommission loading doors and harden Server Room.	Facilities / IT Sec	Q1 2026
Tier 3 High	R3, R8	Detection: Install perimeter fence and 24/7 Monitored IDS.	Facilities / Security	Q2 2026
Tier 4 Medium	R6, R9	Access/Privacy: Implement 2FA Access Control and conduct CCTV Privacy Impact Assessment.	IT Security Manager	Q3 2026

Note: An additional physical security assessment is recommended to be conducted prior to planned revisions to the *Nova Scotia Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (FOIPOP)* in 2027.

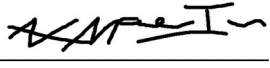
5.0 CONCLUSION

The physical security posture of the 'E' Wing is currently highly insufficient for handling of sensitive government data. If the option exists to find another building, it may be The facility relies on legacy industrial infrastructure that offers little resistance to unauthorized access. However, through extensive and lengthy hardening and perimeter security processes using the Management Action Plan, this facility

can achieve compliance. A school's passive security stance needs to evolve meet a government's active models for compliance with provincial and federal standards.

Auditor Name: Alex MacIntyre

Date: December 11th, 2025

Signature: 

REFERENCES

Government of Canada Policies:

- Treasury Board of Canada Secretariat. (2019). Policy on Government Security.
<https://www.tbs-sct.canada.ca/pol/doc-eng.aspx?id=16578>
- Treasury Board of Canada Secretariat. (2019). Directive on Security Management.
<https://www.tbs-sct.canada.ca/pol/doc-eng.aspx?id=32611>
- Royal Canadian Mounted Police. (2009). Harmonized Threat and Risk Assessment (TRA) Methodology. <https://publications.gc.ca/site/eng/9.845156/publication.html>

Provincial Legislation:

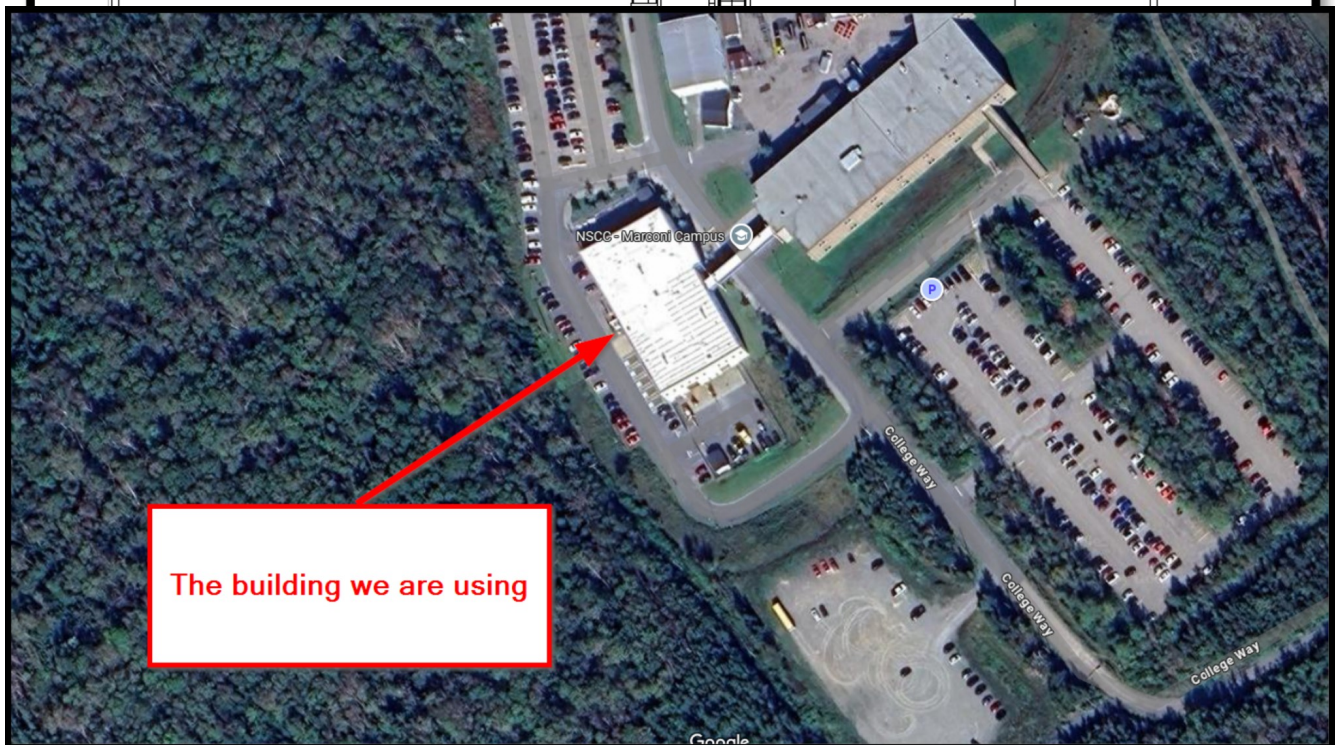
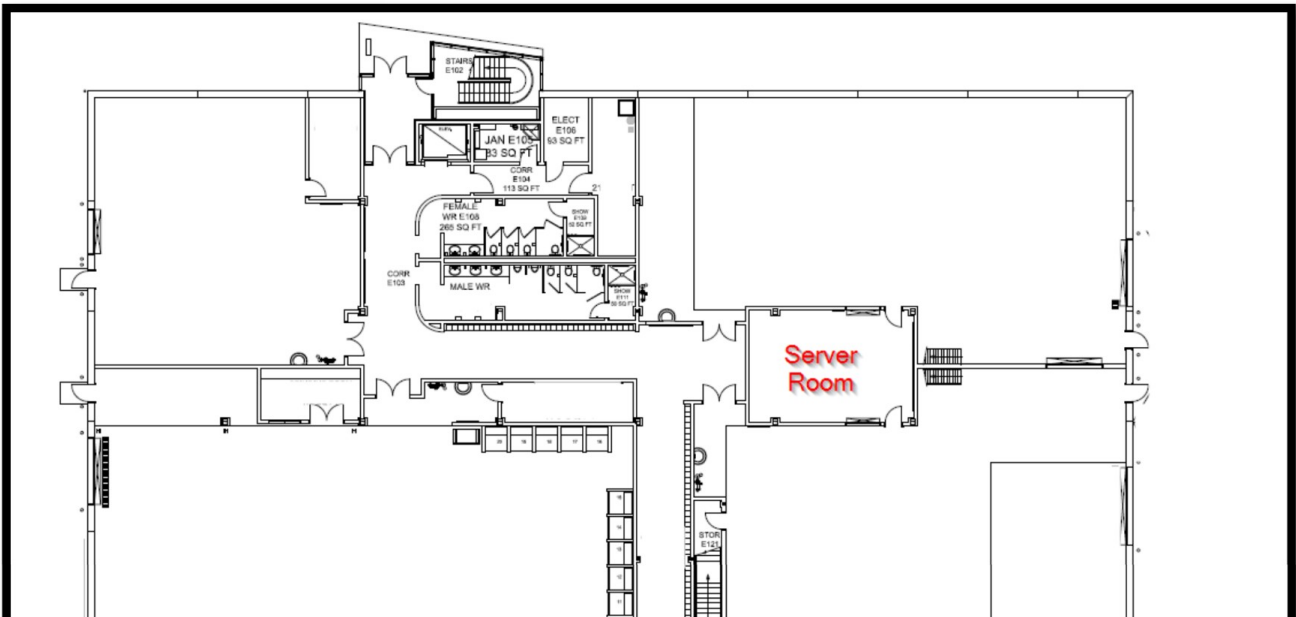
- Province of Nova Scotia. (1993). Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (FOIPOP) and Personal Information International Disclosure Protection Act (PIIDPA).
<https://www.novascotia.ca/information-access-and-privacy-legislation-and-policies-overview>
- *Office to the Information and Privacy Commissioner of Nova Scotia (2019) Video Surveillance Guidelines*
<https://oipc.novascotia.ca/sites/default/files/publications/Video%20Surveillance%20Guidelines%202019%2012%2004.pdf>

Best Practices:

- Institute of Internal Auditors. (2016). *International Standards for the Professional Practice of Internal Auditing*

<https://www.theiia.org/en/content/guidance/mandatory/standards/international-standards-for-the-professional-practice-of-internal-auditing/>

- Crown-Indigenous Relations and Northern Affairs Canada (2017) – Audit of Physical Security <https://www.rcaanc-cirnac.gc.ca/eng/1534347338310/1542719940631>



Email to permits@cbrm.ns.ca (from prior ISEC2078 assignment)



Macintyre, Alexander

To: permits@cbrm.ns.ca <Permits@cbrm.ns.ca>



Sun 9/21/2025 3:46 PM

Hello,

I've been tasked with finding information about the CBRM's fencing by-laws.

While I was able to find information on queries regarding the [B-100 Barbed Wire Fences By-Law](#), I need some help with the following:

1. What is the maximum height permissible for a corporate fence in CBRM?
2. Are the fences permitted to be electrified?

I've read the [Land Use By-Law](#) and [Nova Scotia Building Code Regulations](#), but was unable to find information specifically on fencing.

Thank you,

Alex MacIntyre



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Permits <Permits@cbrm.ns.ca>

To: Macintyre, Alexander



Wed 9/24/2025 9:44 AM

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Good morning,

There is no fence bylaw, and no permit is needed to construct a fence. A citizen is allowed to build a fence ON THEIR OWN PROPERTY (must not use the neighbouring property to build) and there is no height restriction. Any fencing over 8 ft would need to have engineered plans as the builder would need to show that they have been constructed in a safe way.

Fences must not be electrified UNLESS it is on Agriculture designated land and is used for pasture or protection of crops.

Regards,

Jessica Dauphinee

License/Permit Clerk

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